

PCMark 04

In the PCMark 04 test, too, the Sony VAIO and Acer TravelMate scored 3,188 and 3,090 respectively, and stayed way ahead of the others.

DisplayMate

DisplayMate tests the quality of the LCD display. After all the testing, we concluded that the Sony VAIO had a very good display. Not only did it pass the DisplayMate Test in style, the viewing angle was wide as well: movies were viewable even at 160 degrees without discolouration.

Battery Life

The Fujitsu LBP7010 had a battery life of three hours and 45 minutes—more than enough for any movie out there. The Acer TravelMate clocked three hours and 22 minutes. The MSI Megabook S270 came in last, with the battery lasting just an hour and 15 minutes!

Wi-Fi Test

The NetCPS score of the MSI S270 was the highest at 2.16, while the Fujitsu LBS6240 scored 2.1 to come in second. The MSI Megabook S260 was the last in this test with a score of 1.89. To copy the 100 MB of assorted files over a wireless network, Samsung's Q30 Plus took 44.5 seconds, which was the fastest. The Sony VAIO was the slowest, taking 54 seconds to copy the files.

Flaunt Value

'Flaunt value' is a parameter we included in the laptop comparison test this time, because the laptops we included are specifically meant for the lifestyle segment of the market.

The Sony VAIO was in a class of its own in this segment, be it for the excellent design and looks or the form factor or the great specs. It was the only laptop to feature the powerful nVidia GeForce 6200 card, which helped it ace the gaming tests with the others miles behind.

It also had the best and the largest LCD display in this segment. And unlike most laptops, it's comfortable to use for extended periods of time. But the real surprise was some of the peripherals. There was a dual-layer DVD burner incorporated into a unit as small as this! With its superior design, looks, built quality, features and specifications as well as brand value, the Sony VAIO scored the highest flaunt value rating of 7.95.

Close behind was the Fujitsu LBS6240, with a rating of 7.14. Good looks and solid build quality contributed towards the rating. Moreover, it was the most complete package, and included such features as fingerprint recognition.

The fingerprint sensor can be programmed as a scroll button for vertical scrolling using the provided software. Ergonomically, too, this laptop was good.

The fact that it also featured a 13.3-inch LCD display which, along with that of the Sony VAIO, was the largest in this category, helped it no end!

The Fujitsu LBP7010 sported the smallest form factor and also some nifty features. With features like fingerprint recognition and an integrated optical drive, coupled with its build quality and design, this was one excellent laptop.

To top it all, it had an 80 GB hard drive. The LBP7010 also featured an SD, MS, MS Pro and CF card reader, which even its larger sibling did not. The Fujitsu brand also helped when it came to the flaunt value of this laptop.

We gave the Dell Latitude X1 the same flaunt value rating as the Fujitsu LBP7010. The X1 had better build quality and seemed more rugged. It came with an extra battery pack as well.

Conclusion

The Fujitsu laptops were the most expensive of the lot. The LBP7010 costs Rs 1,10,000 whereas the LBS6240 costs Rs 1,25,000. The Acer costs Rs 84,999, has better features, and performs better

Fujitsu LifeBook LBT4010

The Fujitsu LifeBook LBT4010 was not included alongside the other laptops in the main comparison test because it is not just a standard laptop: it's much more. It's a convertible notebook that transforms into a tablet PC when you rotate its swivel-hinged 12.1-inch LCD display.

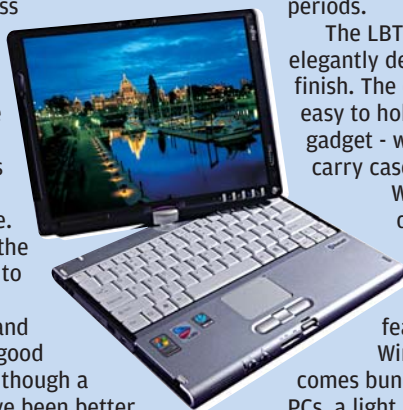
It is Intel Centrino Mobile certified, and sports an Intel Pentium M 1600 MHz processor with 512 MB of DDR RAM running at 333 MHz. There's a 60 GB hard drive and a combo drive.

The WiFi is based on high-speed 802.11 b+g. There's Gigabit LAN, a 56 Kbps modem, Bluetooth and infrared. However, there are only two USB ports. Still, there's a port replicator bundled, should you feel the need for more ports. There is a FireWire IEEE 1394 port to capture high bandwidth video from sources supporting this interface, such as DVCams. Memory cards such as SD, MS

and MS Pro are also supported.

In the tests we performed, the LBT4010 scored a healthy 20.1 in the ZD-Bench Business Winstone 2004 test. In the battery test, it played the movie for a good 185 minutes, which is good enough for almost any movie. Couple this with the D-Sub connector to connect a large-screen monitor, and you have here a good movie machine - though a TV-out would have been better.

The LBT4010 sports Dolby Digital Virtual 5.1-channel stereo speakers, which produce pseudo-surround sound with stereo speakers.



Ergonomically, the laptop is above average, which means the keyboard and the touchpad can be used for long periods.

The LBT4010, like its predecessors, is elegantly designed, with a rich black finish. The contoured design makes it easy to hold. At 1.95 kg, this sleek gadget - which comes with a leather carry case - is light.

With an integrated optical drive, this laptop/tablet PC provides the comfort and ease of carrying of an ultra-portable with all the features of a workhorse laptop. Windows XP Tablet Edition comes bundled. And as with all tablet PCs, a light pen is also bundled. Driver CDs, recovery CDs and other OEM software are bundled as well.

The Fujitsu LifeBook LBT4010 is priced at Rs 1,30,000 - just right!